welcomed American involvement in certain projects in Nepal. Foreign Secretary R. K. Nehru and Joint Secretary T. N. Kaul had also encouraged—and Prime Minister Nehru agreed to—coordination between Nepal, India, and the US, ideally without rousing Chinese suspicions.[166] Subsequently, Washington, recognizing India's role in keeping Nepal out of the Chinese orbit, consulted and coordinated with Delhi on Nepal.[167] Dutt favorably compared this American approach with that of the Soviets, who were not keeping India informed of their activities in Nepal.[168]

A third subject of Indian concern was Beijing's behavior in Tibet. Nehru thought its "forcible occupation," with no sign of the promised autonomy, was only increasing resentment.[169] Policymakers also felt that Beijing was trying to limit India's ties with Tibet, evading and then nixing the establishment of an air link,[170] asking India to remove its wireless station there,[171] expressing unhappiness with Indian trade agencies,[172] mistreating Indian traders,[173] and dissuading a visit by Nehru.[174]

Contrasting Approaches

Even before the situation in Tibet had deteriorated, the Chinese attitude toward events abroad had raised questions about the fate of Panchsheel and highlighted Sino-Indian differences on perception and approach. In talks with Nehru, Zhou defended the Soviet crackdown in Hungary in 1956. For him, the sustainability of the socialist system was essential, and if that called for Soviet intervention and use of force against "subversives"—even if it went against the Panchsheel spirit of noninterference—so be it. The Indian prime minister, on the other hand, saw the Hungarians as nationalists protesting foreign control. He thought their wishes were crucial, and "Shooting down is not any solution."[175]

Doubts about the Chinese approach only increased. In spring 1957, Nehru lamented publicly that "peaceful coexistence" was much "bandied about," but "not acted upon by even those people who use those words."[176] Then, after a short period of relaxation in 1958, Indian officials perceived a return to rigidity in both Beijing and Moscow. Nehru felt that domestically China had gone from "Let a hundred flowers bloom" to "the flowers [have] become weeds to be pulled out."[177]

Externally, China's reaction to two developments in summer 1958 disturbed Indian officials. One involved Yugoslavia, which had reiterated its